# Integrated Science
# WACE written examination—2010 design brief
# Stage 3

**Time allowed**
Reading time before commencing work: ten minutes
Working time for paper: three hours

**Permissible items**
Standard items: pens, pencils, eraser, correction fluid, ruler, highlighter
Special items: non-programmable scientific calculator, drawing instruments, and templates

**Additional information**
The examination places an emphasis on open-ended, extended answer questions. Each question contains a scenario where information is given in discrete parts. Linked questions are sequenced to increase in complexity.

The examination is presented in a question/answer booklet with a separate multiple-choice answer sheet. A data insert sheet (A4 booklet size) is provided if required.

| Section | Supporting information |
|---|---|
| **Section One**<br>**Multiple-choice**<br>20% of the written exam<br>20 questions<br>Suggested working time: 30 minutes | Questions sample student understanding of scientific method and scientific concepts. Candidates indicate their answers on the separate multiple-choice answer sheet provided. |
| **Section Two**<br>**Short answer and problem-solving**<br>50% of the written exam<br>4–6 questions<br>Suggested working time: 90 minutes | Questions are structured as a sequence of items linked to a variety of scenarios. Questions provide opportunities for candidates to apply learned concepts, principles and strategies to solve problems set in unfamiliar scenarios. Questions may involve descriptions, diagrams, tables or graphs.<br><br>At least one question in this section samples the candidate's understanding of experimental design in an unfamiliar investigation. The remaining questions sample the candidate's understanding of scientific concepts. |
| **Section Three**<br>**Extended answer**<br>30% of the written exam<br>Two questions<br>Suggested working time: 60 minutes | Questions are holistic nature with some scaffolding provided. Candidates demonstrate their ability to synthesise key concepts across scientific disciplines to evaluate a range of perspectives. Candidates interpret and respond to questions that may include stimulus materials such as diagrams, second-hand data, excerpts from publications and recent research findings. The stimulus material should not exceed one page in length.<br><br>Questions sample the candidate's understanding of scientific concepts and the impact of science. |

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